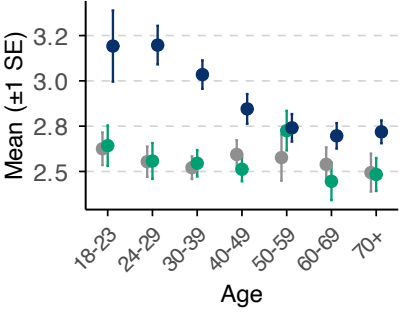
Need wealthy family to get ahead

GSS, 1987-2021 data

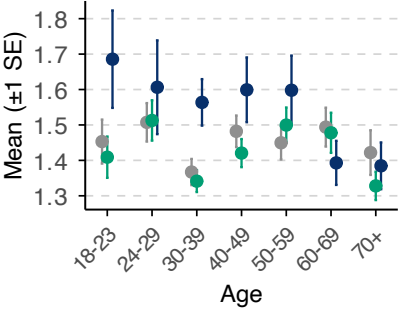
5=Essential
1=Not important at all



Luck or help matters more than hard work for getting ahead

GSS, 1973-2022 data

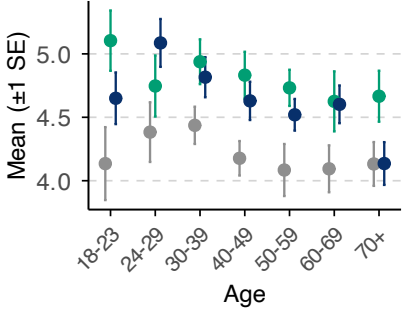
3=Luck matters most
1=Hard work matters most



Wealth is zero-sum – people can only get rich at others' expense

WVS (US), 1995-2011 data

10=Only get rich at others' expense
1=Wealth can grow for everyone



1987 2000 2021

1973 1998 2022

1995 2006 2011